



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Arise Classical Academy
School Website: <https://ariseclassicalacademy.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Arise Classical Academy (<https://www.ariseclassicalacademy.com>) presents strong textual evidence of a classical Christian identity: it explicitly centers education on Christ and Scripture, affirms the transcendentals of truth, goodness, and beauty, commits to formation (wisdom and virtue) over mere information, and names the trivium and quadrivium as curricular pillars. Pedagogically, the school references chants/singing in the grammar stage and rich discussion in upper grades, though it lacks explicit "Socratic"/"scholé" language. Faculty language is emerging but thin. Parent partnership and formation are notably strong via its University-Model structure and an EQUIP discipleship/parent training program.

Most impactful signals: - Religious-metaphysical and purpose statements repeatedly invoke truth, goodness, beauty; Christ-centered integration across subjects; and worship practices (choir, hymns) as part of school life. - Curriculum affirmations include the trivium and quadrivium; Latin; Western heritage; and a classical text set (Humanitas, Lost Tools of Writing, Canon Press Logic, Apologia). - Pedagogical references include chants/songs (grammar stage) and rich discussion; choir/hymnody also featured, though "Socratic" and "scholé" terms are not yet used. - Strong parent partnership (parents as primary educators in a University-Model), with explicit parent formation (book clubs, worship, training) via EQUIP.

Scoring framework and lexicon: All keyword analyses below reference the positive/negative indicator sets from Six Essential Elements of a Classical School and the classicality lexicon organized by the six elements (e.g., transcendental terms; theology/liturgy; formation; trivium/quadrivium; Socratic/chant/scholé; faculty-as-mentors; partnership with parents).

Detailed Classicality Audit

School audited: Arise Classical Academy (Pittsburgh, PA) Website: <https://www.ariseclassicalacademy.com>

Note on method: For each category below, I 1) list keywords/phrases found on the school's site, 2) compare them to the Positive/Negative keyword indicators from Six Essential Elements and the lexicon, and 3) quantify positive vs. negative hits, estimate coverage, and assign a rating.

References to the school site are cited inline; references to the keyword frameworks are cited to the Six Elements and lexicon documents.

1) Religious and Metaphysical Foundations

1) Keywords/phrases found on site

- Transcendentals and formation language: “love of truth, beauty, and goodness” (vision); “classical virtues” and reclaiming “the good, true, and beautiful” (values).
- Theology and integration: “grounded in Scripture and Biblical values,” “Christ is the center of all subjects... think deeply about God’s Word throughout the day” (values, mission/vision).
- Liturgical/communal practices and sacred music: “All students will sing in the choir and make a joyful noise unto the Lord... singing the great hymns of the past” (Fine Arts); WORSHIP program that prepares students to lead congregational worship (extracurriculars).
- Objective aesthetic standards: explicit denial of “aesthetic relativism” and affirmation of standards in pursuit of beauty (Statement of Faith – initial version).

2) Comparison to keyword framework

- Positive matches: truth/goodness/beauty; virtue/wisdom; theology/Christian worldview; liturgy/worship/choir/hymnody; reverence/beauty; objective order (anti-relativism) align strongly with Positive indicators for this element.
- Negative terms (e.g., secular/values-neutral, relativism) are absent; in fact, aesthetic relativism is rejected explicitly.

3) Tally and rating

- Pos/Neg hits: +12 / -0
 - Percent positive: 1.00
 - Coverage estimate: 0.85 (broad coverage across transcendental language, theological integration, and liturgical practices)
 - Rating: CLASSICAL
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2) School Purpose and Goal

1) Keywords/phrases found on site

- Formation aims: “more invested in forming the soul,” “make disciples,” “cultivate character, faith, and learning,” “choose virtue over vocation,” “loving to learn > loving to earn”.
- Transcendentals as goals: “love of truth, beauty, and goodness” (Vision).

2) Comparison to keyword framework

- Positive matches: formation, virtue, wisdom, truth/goodness/beauty, telos of human excellence (vs. job prep focus) align with the Positive indicators for Purpose/Goal.
- Negative terms (e.g., “college and career ready,” 21st-century skills framing) are absent; the site explicitly deprioritizes vocation-first language (“virtue over vocation”).

3) Tally and rating

- Pos/Neg hits: +10 / -0
 - Percent positive: 1.00
 - Coverage estimate: 0.80
 - Rating: CLASSICAL
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3) School Curriculum

1) Keywords/phrases found on site

- Seven Liberal Arts: explicit emphasis on trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and quadrivium (arithmetic, geometry, astronomy, harmonics).
- Classical languages and Western heritage: Latin program emphasis, Western canon/heritage; Augustine named as exemplar; Humanitas, Latin Alive, Lost Tools of Writing, Canon Press Logic, Apologia science (curriculum sampling).
- Great books/primary sources and conversation: “rich discussion,” “great literature” integrated with God at the center of subjects.

2) Comparison to keyword framework

- Positive matches: trivium/quadrivium; Latin/classical languages; Western canon/heritage; great literature/primary sources; integration across subjects—strongly aligned with Positive indicators for curriculum and the liberal arts tradition.
- Negative curriculum signals (“social studies” in lieu of “history,” STEM-first, project-based dominance) are absent.

3) Tally and rating

- Pos/Neg hits: +11 / -0
 - Percent positive: 1.00
 - Coverage estimate: 0.75
 - Rating: CLASSICAL
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4) School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods

1) Keywords/phrases found on site

- Grammar-stage methods: “students learn through songs and chants in the grammar stage” (trivium model explanation).
- Upper-school practices: “rich discussion” (rhetoric-stage aim); emphasis on logic and rhetoric stages for questioning/communication; choir/hymn singing throughout.
- Restful learning/scholé: implied via “Haven > Hustle,” family time, and not “checking boxes,” but the explicit term scholé does not appear ; contrast with the scholé ideal outlined in the reference text.

2) Comparison to keyword framework

- Positive matches present: chanting/singing; memory through music; rich discussion aligned to dialectic/rhetoric aims.
- Gaps: no explicit “Socratic,” “dialectic,” “seminar,” or “scholé” language. Given grades 9–12 are targeted, an explicit Socratic or seminar claim would strengthen alignment.
- Negative pedagogy terms (project-based-only, experiential-only, student-directed constructs) are absent.

3) Tally and rating

- Pos/Neg hits: +6 / -0
 - Percent positive: 1.00
 - Coverage estimate: 0.55 (good foundation, but missing explicit Socratic/scholé vocabulary expected in 9–12)
 - Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
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5) School Faculty

1) Keywords/phrases found on site

- Faculty modeling/mentorship: teacher bio featuring “passionate about mentoring and caring for students” (example: teacher page).
- Portrait language: “Portrait of a Graduate” exists, but no explicit “Portrait of a Teacher”/“faculty of friends” language evident on the site fragments reviewed.

2) Comparison to keyword framework

- Positive indicators in the framework emphasize teachers as models/mentors, the “living curriculum,” collegial culture, portrait of a teacher, and classical formation for faculty.
- Evidence here is emerging but limited to mentoring language in at least one profile.

3) Tally and rating

- Pos/Neg hits: +2 / -0
 - Percent positive: 1.00
 - Coverage estimate: 0.30 (thin public articulation)
 - Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
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6) School Parents and Community

1) Keywords/phrases found on site

- Parent partnership: “partner with parents,” “parents are the primary educators” in the University-Model; school assists with instruction, transcripts, and support days; hybrid homeschooling partnership.
- Parent formation/community: EQUIP discipleship (book clubs, worship, special speakers, parent training); “Get involved” community invitation.

2) Comparison to keyword framework

- Strong alignment to Positive indicators: partnership with parents/co-teachers, parent formation via reading groups/training, intentional community practices aligned to faith and classical aims.

3) Tally and rating

- Pos/Neg hits: +6 / -0
 - Percent positive: 1.00
 - Coverage estimate: 0.85
 - Rating: CLASSICAL
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Aggregate Assessment

- Category ratings: Religious/Metaphysical (Classical), Purpose/Goal (Classical), Curriculum (Classical), Pedagogy (Somewhat Classical), Faculty (Somewhat Classical), Parents/Community (Classical).
- Overall: CLASSICAL

Rationale: The school clearly meets most criteria. Its religious-metaphysical foundation, purpose, curriculum, and parent/community commitments strongly align with the Six Elements’ positive indicators. Pedagogy and faculty articulation are trending well but could benefit from more explicit classical vocabulary and public documentation consistent with the positive indicators list (e.g., Socratic seminar, scholé; portrait of a teacher).

Element-by-Element Keyword Matrices

Note: “Positives” reference matches to positive keyword indicators; “Negatives” reference matches to negative indicators in the Six Elements/lexicon.

- Religious & Metaphysical
- Positives: truth, goodness, beauty; Christ-centered; Scripture; Christian worldview; worship, choir, hymns; anti-relativism; aesthetic standards.
- Negatives: none found.
- Purpose & Goal
- Positives: formation of the soul; discipleship; virtue; wisdom; love of learning; truth/beauty/goodness; virtue over vocation.
- Negatives: none found.
- Curriculum
- Positives: trivium; quadrivium; Latin; Western heritage/canon; rich discussion; great literature; Humanitas; Lost Tools of Writing; logic; Apologia science.
- Negatives: none found (no “social studies” replacement; no STEM-first framing).
- Pedagogy
- Positives: chants/songs in grammar stage; rich discussion; choir/hymns; logic/rhetoric stages emphasized.
- Negatives: none found (no “project-based dominance”/constructivist language).
- Gaps (coverage only): no explicit “Socratic,” “seminar,” or “scholé” terms; scholé as restful learning is a recognized classical aim in the reference tradition.
- Faculty
- Positives: mentoring language in teacher bio(s).
- Negatives: none found.
- Gaps: no “portrait of a teacher,” “faculty as living curriculum,” or explicit faculty formation language publicly visible.
- Parents & Community
- Positives: parents as primary educators; partnership with parents; EQUIP discipleship (book clubs, parent training, worship); community invitations to participate.
- Negatives: none found.

Notes and Evidence Highlights

- Grades: “Pittsburgh’s 9th–12th Grade Christ-Centered University-Model Program”.
- Model and memberships: University-Model; membership in NAUMS and ACCS listed in FAQ/accreditation section.
- Curricular exemplars: “Humanitas and Latin Alive (Classical Academic Press), Math-U-See, Apologia science, Lost Tools of Writing, Canon Press Logic”.
- Latin/Western tradition rationale: Augustine, Western canon, Western civilization, truth/beauty/goodness in language study.

Recommendations to Strengthen Public Classical Signaling

- Pedagogy vocabulary: Add explicit “Socratic seminar,” “dialectic,” “Harkness,” “disputation,” and “rhetorical orations/thesis defenses” (for 11th–12th) on Academics/Pedagogy pages, aligning with the pedagogy indicators.

- Restful learning (scholé): Name the scholé ideal and how your schedule/culture practices it; draw on The Scholé Way/Leisure tradition language to frame contemplation and “restfulness” as integral to learning.
- Faculty formation: Publish a “Portrait of a Teacher” and a brief note on faculty classical formation (mentoring, great books seminars, collegial culture), matching the faculty indicators.
- Great Books list: Consider a public “selected readings”/Great Books overview to emphasize primary-source engagement and the Great Conversation.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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